Rich Toward God

Luke 12:13-21 (KJV)

Scripture

Luke 12:13-21

13 And one of the company said unto him, Master, speak to my brother, that he divide the inheritance with
me. 14 And he said unto him, Man, who made me a judge or a divider over you? 15 And he said unto them,
Take heed, and beware of covetousness: for a man's life consisteth not in the abundance of the things
which he possesseth. 16 And he spake a parable unto them, saying, The ground of a certain rich man brought
forth plentifully: 17 And he thought within himself, saying, What shall I do, because I have no room where to
bestow my fruits? 18 And he said, This will I do: I will pull down my barns, and build greater; and there will I
bestow all my fruits and my goods. 19 And I will say to my soul, Soul, thou hast much goods laid up for many
years; take thine ease, eat, drink, and be merry. 20 But God said unto him, Thou fool, this night thy soul shall
be required of thee: then whose shall those things be, which thou hast provided? 21 So is he that layeth up
treasure for himself, and is not rich toward God.

Outline

1. Life is more than possessions

A man's life consisteth not in the abundance of the things which he _____.

Things cannot fill a soul made for _____.

Read: Luke 12:13-15; Ecclesiastes 5:10; 1 Timothy 6:6-10

2. The rich man's plans left God out

The rich man said, "I will pull down my _____, and build greater."

His plans left out God, others, and _____.

Read: Luke 12:16-19; James 4:13-15; Proverbs 27:1

3. Be rich toward God

Thou fool, this night thy _____ shall be required of thee.

So is he that layeth up treasure for himself, and is not rich toward _____.

Read: Luke 12:20-21; Matthew 6:19-21; 1 Timothy 6:17-19

Discussion questions

1. Was it wrong for the man to have a good harvest, or to build barns? What was wrong?

2. How does our culture encourage covetousness?

3. What would it look like in practice to be "rich toward God"?

4. How does remembering that life is short help us fight greed?

This week

Take an honest look at your spending and giving this week. Choose one specific way to be "rich toward God": increase a gift, help someone in need, or give away something you do not use. Pray 1 Timothy 6:6: "godliness with contentment is great gain."